TOMORROW'S PM FEEDBACK SESSION

FunnyStudy - Semester Project Part 3, Iteration 2
A practical talk track, demo plan, and user-centered questions

Presenter Shubham	**Target user** Nadia, composite adult study participant
Meeting goal Explain the revision, test assumptions, and get actionable feedback	**Build status** Local app at localhost:3002; no Vercel URL yet

The one thing to remember

You are not going in to convince the PM that a dislike button is good or bad. You are going in to understand what participants need and what the study needs to measure. Show the current experience, explain the small change you made, and ask why the old dislike control was removed before proposing a larger change.

Be accurate: the PM comments you shared are paraphrased, and we do not know whether they were the formal first-round or second-round review. Say that plainly. Do not say the second review is complete until you demonstrate the revision and record the PM's actual feedback.

Your 30-second opening

> *"Thanks for meeting with me. My project is the participant progress and resume experience in FunnyStudy. I'm designing for a participant who may be interrupted and needs to understand what to do and how to continue. You mentioned that dislike was removed and asked me to think about whether it should return. I clarified that participants can move on without voting when they're unsure or don't find a caption funny. Today I'd like to check whether that is clear and understand what the study needs from a negative response before changing the vote controls."*

Meeting flow (about 8-10 minutes)

Time	What to do
0:00-1:00	Introduce Nadia and the participant problem.
1:00-3:00	Demonstrate the revised welcome instructions and show the home progress/archive entry if your signed-in demo is ready.
3:00-7:00	Ask about the dislike decision, participant interpretation, and research data needs.
7:00-9:00	Summarize what you heard; agree on the next experiment/change and record exact feedback.

1. Understand the user, not just the feature

Who is Nadia?

Nadia is a fictional composite adult research participant—not you. She is willing to participate in a humor study, may be interrupted, may not know the research vocabulary, and wants to complete the task without worrying whether she is rating every caption “correctly.” This is a working persona hypothesis, not a fact established by interviews.

A useful way to look through her eyes

- **Goal:** finish the study and express which captions she personally finds funny.
- **Context:** captions may be unclear, culturally unfamiliar, or simply not to her taste; she may be on a phone and may be interrupted.
- **Question in her mind:** “Do I have to react to every caption, and what does a negative response mean?”
- **Design risk:** a forced dislike could make “not funny,” “I don’t understand,” “I’m unsure,” and “I dislike this” seem equivalent.
- **Other design risk:** a heart-only UI can leave people unsure whether skipping is allowed or whether the app recorded anything.

Ask the PM

> *“When you picture a participant going through this study, what situation or confusion do you most want the interface to prevent? Is there a specific participant observation behind the dislike removal?”*

2. What is implemented now

- Home setup checklist for profile, notifications, and demographics.
- Study states and clear actions: Start, Resume, and View Results.
- Authenticated saved checkpoint for caption position and run-level progress/timing; completion returns to saved stats.
- Follow-up: read-only archive of ended public studies, with paginated captions and no vote/progress writes.
- Iteration 2 copy: participants may move on without voting when a caption is not funny or they are unsure.

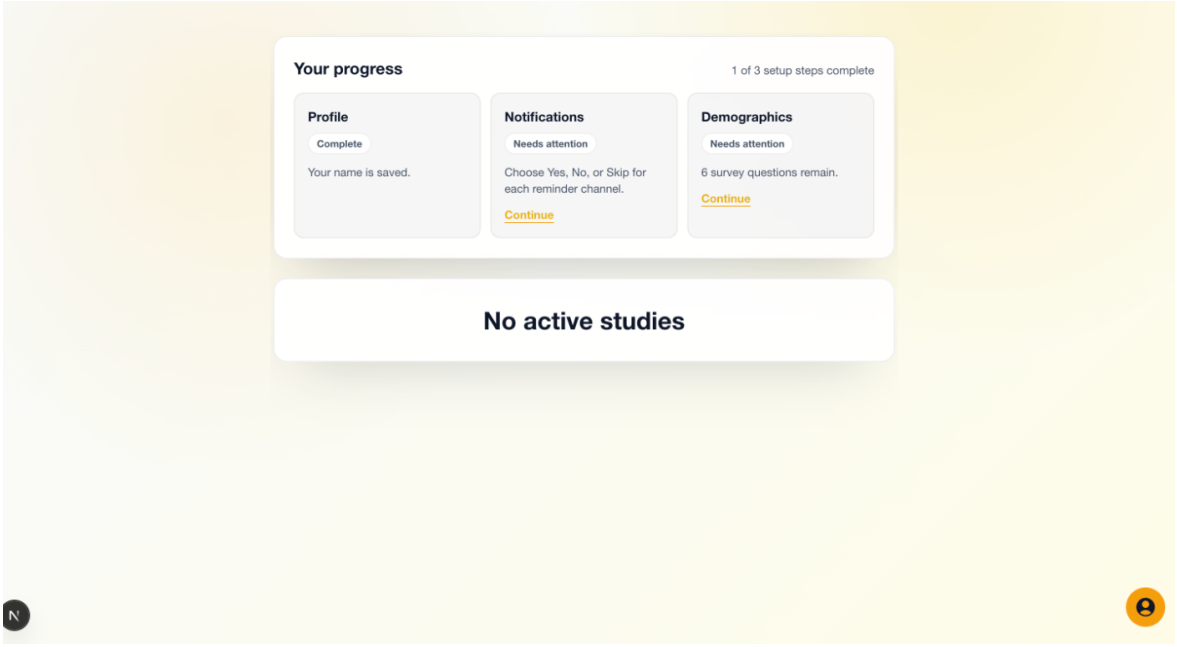
The codebase still has older rating values in types/mappings. That is evidence of prior support, not proof of the team's reason for removing the visible dislike control or proof that negative ratings belong in the current study.

What changed since the last version

Before: “Like the captions you find funny.”	**Now:** also says you can move on without voting if it is not funny or you are unsure.

Participant dashboard reference

Use this screenshot to anchor the conversation in the participant's actual home experience. The version shown has the setup checklist and “No active studies” state; it predates the read-only archive link, which is now shown when there are no active studies.



User-provided screenshot. It is an earlier dashboard state, not the current archive-enabled screenshot.

3. Demo plan: say this while you show it

Before the meeting: open the app at localhost:3002 and confirm Google sign-in works for your own test account. Do not share keys, passwords, or secrets. If sign-in is unavailable, say the limitation and use screenshots/code previews; do not pretend you tested a signed-in study.

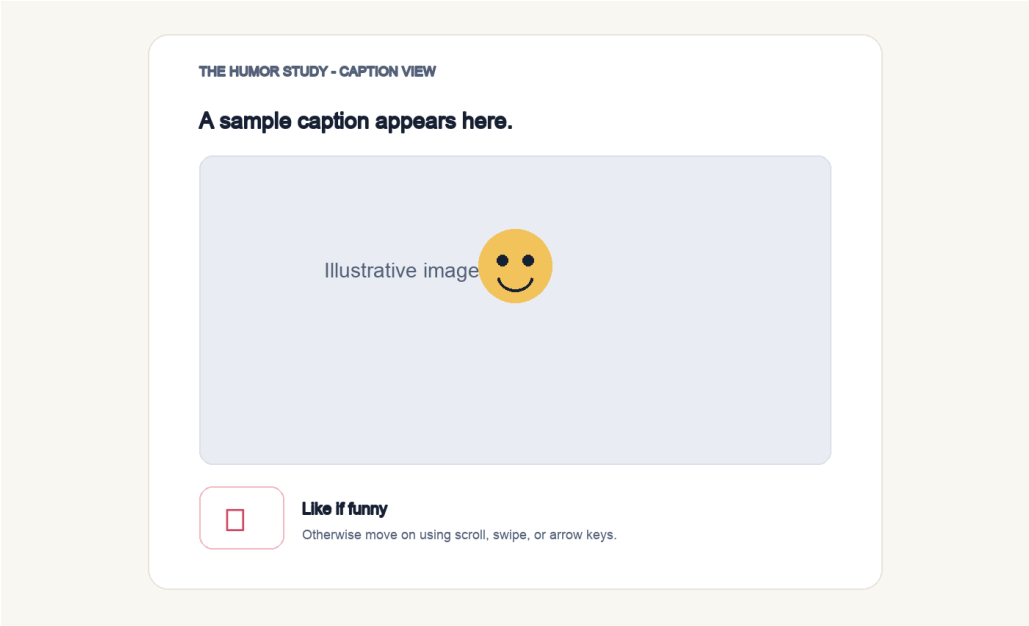
Step A - participant home

Say: "Nadia has to complete a few setup steps before starting. This checklist puts the status in one place. If she returns to an unfinished study, the card tells her to resume and shows the saved caption position."

Point to: the three setup cards; a study card in each state if your test account has them; the archive link if there are no active studies.

Step B - the study start/welcome screen

Say: "This is the wording I changed. It tells a participant that a like is optional for captions that are not funny or uncertain. I deliberately did not add a dislike rating yet because I want to know what it should mean and whether the study needs it."



Illustrative mock-up of the participant choice; not a live application screenshot.

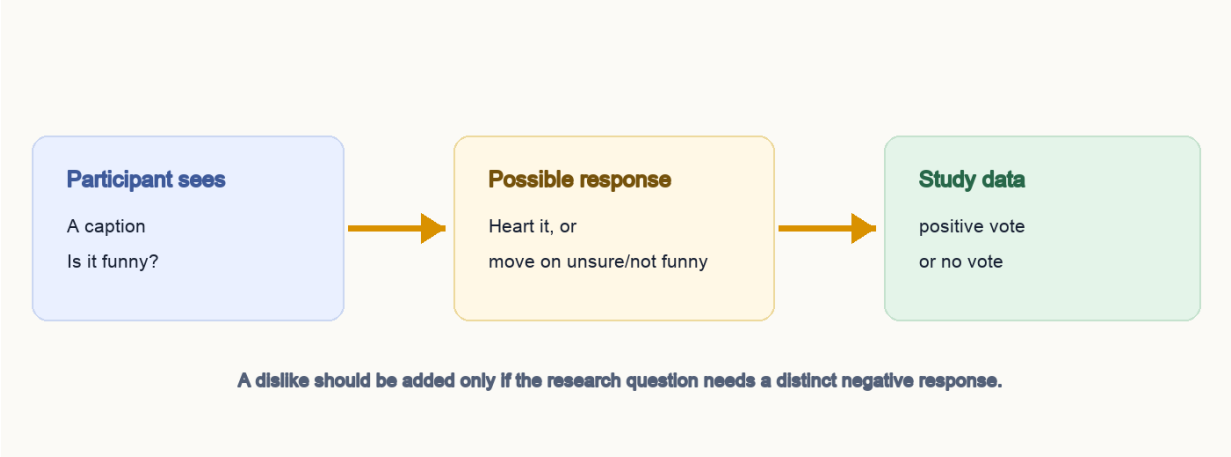
Step C - make the PM do the interpretation

Ask the PM to imagine a caption they do not find funny and ask: "What would you expect to do next? What do you think the study records if you do nothing and move on?" Listen first. Do not explain the answer until they have described their understanding.

Step D - close with a decision

Say: "Based on this, should I keep the optional-like interaction and test its clarity, or is an explicit negative response required by the research? If required, which distinct response should it represent, and what should I validate next?"

4. The dislike question: balanced discussion



How a participant's interpretation connects to study data.

Reasons it may be better not to add dislike

- The task stays simple: select captions that are funny and move past others.
- The participant is not forced into a negative judgment just to proceed.
- A single dislike button may combine several meanings and produce ambiguous data.
- If the research question only needs positive humor preference, the extra control may be unnecessary.

Reasons an explicit negative response may help

- The research may need an explicit comparison between captions participants like and reject.
- Participants may expect a complete rating scale and perceive heart-only as incomplete.
- A well-defined negative choice could reduce missingness—if the protocol actually calls for it.

Questions to ask, in order

- “Why did the team remove dislike? What problem were you seeing?”
- “What exact concept should a negative response measure: not funny, disliked, offensive, confusing, or something else?”
- “Does moving on without a like mean no opinion, not funny, or simply unrecorded? What does the analysis expect?”
- “Would a negative button change participant behavior or bias responses? Is the study protocol approved for this?”
- “What evidence would convince us to keep, remove, or rename it?”

Your recommendation today: keep the behavior unchanged until the PM/research team confirms the intended construct. The small copy change clarifies skipping; it is not a substitute for validating the research instrument.

5. Listen, capture feedback, and agree on next steps

Use these follow-up prompts

- “Can you walk me through what you think this screen is asking the participant to do?”
- “What would be unclear to someone taking the study for the first time?”
- “Which part of the current UI would you change first, and why?”
- “What should I observe or measure next iteration to know it improved?”
- “May I test this wording with a participant, and what research/privacy constraints should I follow?”

Feedback notes - fill in during/after the meeting

PM's exact feedback / quote	
Usefulness: did this solve a real user problem?	
Clarity: what did the PM think skip/dislike meant?	
Behavior: did the demo behave as expected?	
Decision about negative vote / why	
Next change, owner, and evidence to collect	

End the meeting by reflecting back

> *“Let me check I understood: the main user issue is ____. You recommend I ____ because ____. I’ll validate it by ____. Is that an accurate summary?”*

6. Practical checklist for tomorrow

Before

- Confirm your local app loads at **http://localhost:3002**. This address only works on your computer/network.
- Test your own Google sign-in and make sure you can reach a signed-in participant page. If it fails, prepare to show the login page and source screenshot; do not spend the PM meeting debugging OAuth.
- Prepare a test account and a safe demo study only if already available. Do not change real study dates or participant records to create a demo.
- Have this guide and the Iteration 2 progress update ready; write down the PM's actual words and the review date.
- Do not display `.env.local`, any API key, database password, OAuth client secret, or other credentials.

During

- Start with the participant and their context, not a list of code changes.
- Ask the PM to think aloud; avoid leading them toward your preferred feature.
- Separate research needs (what data must be measured) from UI choice (which control communicates it).
- If you do not know an answer, say you will verify it; do not guess why the old control was removed.

After

- Update the Iteration 2 report with the actual review date, feedback, decision, and planned next changes.
- Only claim feedback-based implementation after the PM has provided feedback and the change is implemented and checked.
- Deploy to Vercel if the assignment needs a PM-reviewable public URL. At present, no Vercel URL is recorded; localhost is not deploy evidence.

Honest status to tell the PM

> *“This version is running locally. I do not have a Vercel deployment URL yet. I can show the local flow today, and I will send the deployed link after I deploy and verify the signed-in workflow.”*

One-sentence takeaway

Design from the participant's viewpoint, preserve the meaning of the research data, and let evidence—not assumptions—decide whether dislike belongs in the interface.